

Migration by Numbers

Grades 5–8 • Math • Yellow Level

Yellow Level: Grade Level

Name: _____ Date: _____ Period: _____

Data: Chicago's Black population — 1910: 44,103 | 1920: 109,458 | 1930: 233,903 | 1940: 277,731 | 1950: 492,265 | 1960: 812,637

Formula: Percentage change = $(\text{New} - \text{Old}) \div \text{Old} \times 100$

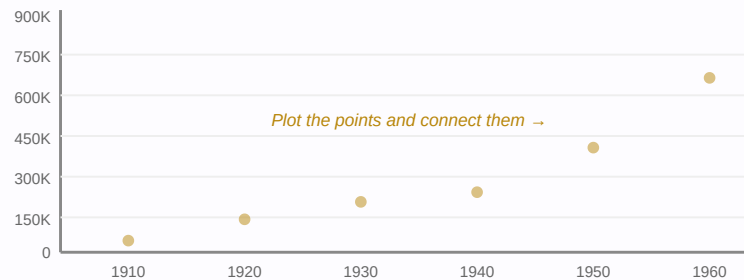
ACTIVITY 1: COMPLETE THE PERCENTAGE CHANGE TABLE

Chicago's Black Population Growth by Decade

Decade	Start population	End population	Change (absolute)	% Change (show working)
1910–1920	44,103	109,458		
1920–1930	109,458	233,903		
1930–1940	233,903	277,731		
1940–1950	277,731	492,265		
1950–1960	492,265	812,637		

ACTIVITY 2: CREATE A LINE GRAPH

Plot Chicago's Black population (y-axis: 0 to 900,000) against year (x-axis: 1910 to 1960). Connect the points and label each one.



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ACTIVITY 3: INTERPRET AND COMPARE

Which decade shows the highest percentage change? _____ Which shows the highest absolute change?

Why are these different? Explain in your own words:

New York's Black population in 1960 was 1,087,931. Chicago's was 812,637. Calculate the ratio of New York to Chicago (simplify to nearest whole number):

ACTIVITY 4: WHAT THE DATA SHOWS — AND DOESN'T

Census population data shows how many people moved. Write two things the data shows clearly, and two things it cannot tell us about the Great Migration:

The data SHOWS us...	The data CANNOT tell us...

Mini Museum Connection

The **Great Migration Map** in the exhibition shows six origin cities and four destination cities. Use your percentage change data: which destination city grew proportionally fastest? What might explain that pattern?

minimuseumproject.com/exhibitions/harlem-renaissance

Extension: The 1930s shows the slowest growth in the data. Research: what was happening in America in the 1930s that might explain this? (Hint: think about employment and the economy.)